



MICRO-BUBBLES

This lung photomicrograph, taken with a scanning electron microscope, shows red blood cells spilling from a capillary in the center. Around are cavelike air spaces of the alveoli, less than 0.004 in (0.1 mm) wide.

RESPIRATORY SYSTEM

The heart sits snugly between the two lungs. The right lung has three lobes, while the left has only two lobes with a space hollowed out for the heart. Low-oxygen blood flows from the right side of the heart along the pulmonary arteries to the lungs. Recharged with oxygen and having discharged carbon dioxide, blood returns along the pulmonary veins to the heart's left side for distribution throughout the body.

Nerves (pp. 58-59)

Windpipe
(trachea)

Aorta taking
oxygenated blood
around body

Upper lobe
of right lung

Pulmonary
artery
taking blood
to right lung

Right atrium of
heart (pp. 28-29)

Middle lobe
of right lung

Bottom lobe
of right lung

Pulmonary artery
taking blood to
both lungs

Pulmonary vein
returning blood
from left lung

Left atrium of
heart (pp. 28-29)

Upper lobe
of left lung

Lower lobe
of left lung

Esophagus
(pp. 34-35)

Heart

Aorta